

The Chart and the States

All 111 relations under our 17 names, what each one teaches, and how the argument survives a daemon that is two things at once. And, for review first: one rule for how every screen uses a type's colour, hues for the two types that never had one, and a mark on each move that says what it does.

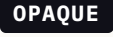
Under review. Everything marked **PROPOSED** is a recommendation, not the game. Nothing here has touched the ROM: the colours are decided on this page first, then built.

Colour: one hue per type, and one step of it for words

Every type keeps its one hue. ramp5 already turns that hue into five steps, and sprites use all five. Anything that is a word uses step 4: the ground under a type badge *and* a move name written on the white battle box. It is one colour doing both jobs, because contrast works the same in both directions.

That is the whole of the consistency rule. No hue changes for contrast: step 4 of all 17 is readable as text on white, and white is readable on it. The worst is **FROZEN** at 5.7:1; 4.5:1 is the usual minimum for body text, and the battle box's own grey text is 8.9:1.

TYPE	HUE · SPRITES	BADGE · STEP 4	ON THE BATTLE BOX · STEP 4	CONTRAST
CONTENT	 #c6bca8	CONTENT	CONTENT	6.2
LOGIC	 #607a9e	LOGIC	LOGIC	10.5
VECTOR	 #ce4646	VECTOR	VECTOR	11.4
CORRUPT	 #545c34	CORRUPT	CORRUPT	13.6
STRATUM	 #9e7a4e	STRATUM	STRATUM	9.8
LEGACY	 #82828a	LEGACY	LEGACY	10.1
SWARM	 #809448	SWARM	SWARM	9.4
LATENT	 #5c4676	LATENT	LATENT	15.0
ENTROPY	 #de9e2e	ENTROPY	ENTROPY	7.1
FLOW	 #466ab0	FLOW	FLOW	11.7
GROWTH	 #5c9e60	GROWTH	GROWTH	8.8
SIGNAL	 #56bebe	SIGNAL	SIGNAL	7.0
CONTEXT	 #b0569e	CONTEXT	CONTEXT	11.2
FROZEN	 #a6cede	FROZEN	FROZEN	5.7

TYPE	HUE · SPRITES	BADGE · STEP 4	ON THE BATTLE BOX · STEP 4	CONTRAST
EMERGENT	 #357d6e			11.3
HARDENED 	 #c4aa60			6.9
OPAQUE 	 #28282e			18.9

What darkening costs

At sprite brightness 1 of 136 type pairs sit closer than 20 (CIE76), which this page already treats as the edge of telling two colours apart at 56px. At step 4 it is 27, and a 1-pixel letter is far thinner than a sprite. So a coloured move name tells you the *family* of its type, not the exact type — which is why the type name stays written in the info box. Colour to scan, the word to be sure. That also serves anyone who cannot see the difference at all.

CLOSEST PAIRS AS TEXT	SPRITES	STEP 4
 LOGIC / LEGACY	17.0	7.8
 LOGIC / FLOW	21.1	11.4
 SWARM / HARDENED	21.9	11.6
 SWARM / GROWTH	20.3	12.0
 SIGNAL / FROZEN	23.0	13.2
 CONTENT / FROZEN	28.0	13.6
 STRATUM / HARDENED	21.0	13.7
 CORRUPT / SWARM	27.2	14.2

 LOGIC / LEGACY is 7.8 at step 4 (17.0 at sprite size). The ruling further down — that separating them was "not worth weakening a metaphor for two points" — was made at sprite size. As text they are effectively one colour, so it is worth deciding again: move one of them within its own metaphor, or accept that the info box is the only thing that tells them apart.

 Some words read as plain text, for two different reasons. A hue that sits near the battle box's own grey: CONTENT (11.0), LOGIC (13.2), LEGACY (6.9). A hue too dark and too weak to

show at letter size: CORRUPT, LATENT, EMERGENT, OPAQUE — OCCLUDE and POLLUTE in the mockup are this kind. One alternative: *words take the lightest step that still reads as text* — the hue itself where it already clears 4.5:1 (CORRUPT, LATENT, FLOW, CONTEXT, EMERGENT, OPAQUE), and step 4 otherwise. That fixes CORRUPT, LATENT, EMERGENT, and leaves 20 pairs under 20 instead of 27. It cannot fix CONTENT, LOGIC, LEGACY, OPAQUE: those hues either sit beside the grey or carry almost no colour, at any step. For CONTENT that is the design — the thing itself should not look like anything — and for all of them the mark and the written type do the work. The cost: for the types it changes, a badge and a written name stop sharing one colour.

The two types with no colour

TYPE_COLOR has fifteen entries for 17 types. Today the badge tool gives HARDENED LEGACY's slot and OPAQUE LATENT's, and **the sprite tool skips any daemon whose type has no entry**, so those daemons still wear vanilla colours. Colour cannot be consistent anywhere until these two have one. Each option is measured against all the others; *worst* is its distance to whichever type it sits nearest.

HARDENED DECISION

OPTION	SPRITE · STEP 4	WORST, SPRITES	WORST, STEP 4	NEAREST	TEXT	COLOUR AS A WORD	W
tempered straw recommended	 	21.0	11.6	SWARM	6.9	24.9	T co st ac tu w h — te is p th cl T n ca cl e ty sp si
copper	 	19.4	15.2	ENTROPY	9.9	31.4	S b te co a n w a a th cl

OPTION	SPRITE · STEP 4	WORST, SPRITES	WORST, STEP 4	NEAREST	TEXT	COLOUR AS A WORD	WHY
heat-blued		13.3	13.2	LATENT	15.4	40.8	A te te co a g m b ir b L F L a c

Every grey metal was tried first — gunmetal, titanium, silver, case-hardened — and every one landed within 4–9 of LEGACY, LOGIC or FROZEN. Metal is already crowded in this palette, because LOGIC is steel and LEGACY is slate. The candidates above work by being the colour metal *takes* when it is worked, rather than the colour of metal at rest.

OPAQUE

DECISION

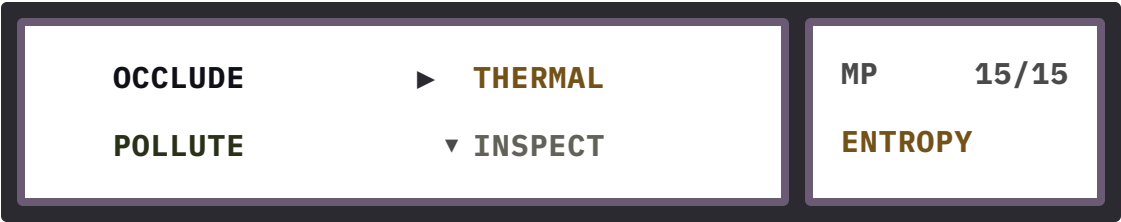
OPTION	SPRITE · STEP 4	WORST, SPRITES	WORST, STEP 4	NEAREST	TEXT	COLOUR AS A WORD	WHY
near-black recommended		27.6	17.9	LATENT	18.9	5.6	A black box is t clause. Clear o every type, a clear of plain to which matters for a ty this dan

OPTION	SPRITE · STEP 4	WORST, SPRITES	WORST, STEP 4	NEAREST	TEXT	COLOUR AS A WORD	WHY
ink navy		22.0	14.1	LATENT	18.8	16.9	Blue enough to still read as a colour when written dark enough to stay a sealed box.
slate ink		20.5	17.8	LEGACY	16.6	11.6	A bluer near-black. Nearly clear, slightly closer to LATENT
oxblood		32.0	17.1	LATENT	17.2	27.7	The most separate at sprite size, but reads as a dark VECTO rather than as something sealed.

"Colour as a word" is the chroma of the colour a move name would actually be written in; under about 10 it reads as plain dark text. Near-black keeps the black box unreadable, which is the clause, and gives up OPAQUE as a legible colour. Oxblood or ink navy do the reverse. Both are defensible — it is a choice about what the type is for.

The move menu: colour for type, a mark for what it does

A move answers two separate questions — *what type is it*, and *what does it do* — so it gets two separate channels. Colour already means type everywhere in this game (the rule at the top of the matrix: *hue is the type, effectiveness is weight, never colour*). What a move does is the same kind of thing as effectiveness, so it gets a shape.



Your screenshot's four: OCCLUDE OPAQUE hit, THERMAL ENTROPY hit, POLLUTE CORRUPT hit, INSPECT CONTENT lower. The three that hit are unmarked; INSPECT lowers the foe's defence and carries ▼. The info box keeps MP and names the highlighted move's type in its colour, without the TYPE/ label. OCCLUDE and POLLUTE show the problem noted above: both read almost as plain text at step 4. The alternative would give POLLUTE its olive back. It would not rescue OCCLUDE, because the proposed OPAQUE hue is itself near-black — which is what the OPAQUE decision below is really about.

CLASS	MARK	MOVES	WHAT IT MEANS	EXAMPLES
HIT	none	217	Deals damage. Unmarked.	ABSTRACT, ACCRUE, ACCUMULATE, AEROBLAST, AMBIENT, AMPLIFY...
RAISE	▲	25	Raises your own stats. No damage.	BLOOM, BRACKET, COMPACT, COMPOSE, COPY STATE, EDDY...
LOWER	▼	18	Lowers the foe's stats. No damage.	ADVERTISE, AUDIT, BACKLOG, BLUR, CLOG, DEFOCUS...
AFFLICT	◆	34	Puts a state or a lasting effect on the foe — suspend, throttle, a trap, a curse. No damage.	ADULTERATE, BLOCK, BROWNOUT, COMPOUND, COUNTDOWN, DEADEND...
MEND	+	15	Restores your health or clears your state.	CLEAR STATE, DEFERRED, DEQUEUE, HEAL BELL, IDLE, LOAD BALANCE...

CLASS	MARK	MOVES	WHAT IT MEANS	EXAMPLES
GUARD	■	9	Protects you or your side.	ASSERT, MAGIC COAT, PARAPHRASE, PROTECT, READONLY, SAFEGUARD...
OTHER	●	37	Everything else: copying, transforming, weather, switching, calling other routines.	ASSIST, ASSUME, ATOMIC, BIT ROT, BLEND, CAST...

Hitting is unmarked on purpose. 217 of 355 moves (61%) deal damage, it is the thing a player most wants to see plainly, and because every other class carries a mark, an unmarked name can only mean one thing. The classes are read off each move's effect and power in the build, not typed.

The marks are 4px. With one in front, every move name still fits its 64px slot (0 would not). The font's own arrows are 8px and 14 names would not fit — EXTRASENSORY, FRENZY PLANT, GRASSWHISTLE, HYDRO CANNON among them. 8 font cells nothing in the game uses — ì í î ï ï í î ï — get redrawn as the marks.

Dropping **TYPE/**. The label is 23px, and with it EMERGENT, HARDENED already run past the info line today. Without it the widest type name is 48px. Showing power there was considered: it does not fit beside the longest names at three digits, and the mark already answers whether a move hits.

The matrix

Rows attack, columns defend. Read LOGIC → CONTEXT as the row LOGIC meeting the column CONTEXT: $\times\frac{1}{2}$, the thesis. Click a type to hold its row and column.

$\times 2$ effective $\times\frac{1}{2}$ resisted $\times 0$ no effect · blank is $\times 1$ Hue is the type (9.4). Effectiveness is weight, never colour.

	CONTENT	LOGIC	VECTOR	CORRUPT	STRATUM	LEGACY	SWARM	LATENT	ENTROPY	FLOW	GROWTH	SIGNAL	CONTEXT	FROZEN	EMERGENT	HARDENED	OPAQUE
CONTENT						$\frac{1}{2}$		0								$\frac{1}{2}$	
LOGIC	2		$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$		2	$\frac{1}{2}$	0					$\frac{1}{2}$	2		2	2
VECTOR		2				$\frac{1}{2}$	2				2	$\frac{1}{2}$				$\frac{1}{2}$	
CORRUPT				$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$		$\frac{1}{2}$			2					0	
STRATUM			0	2		2	$\frac{1}{2}$		2		$\frac{1}{2}$	2				2	
LEGACY		$\frac{1}{2}$	2		$\frac{1}{2}$		2		2					2		$\frac{1}{2}$	
SWARM		$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$				$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$		2		2			$\frac{1}{2}$	2
LATENT	0							2					2			$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$
ENTROPY						$\frac{1}{2}$	2		$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$	2			2	$\frac{1}{2}$	2	
FLOW					2	2			2	$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$				$\frac{1}{2}$		
GROWTH			$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$	2	2	$\frac{1}{2}$		$\frac{1}{2}$	2	$\frac{1}{2}$				$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$	
SIGNAL			2		0					2	$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$			$\frac{1}{2}$		
CONTEXT		2		2				2					$\frac{1}{2}$			$\frac{1}{2}$	0
FROZEN			2		2				$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$	2			$\frac{1}{2}$	2	$\frac{1}{2}$	
EMERGENT															2	$\frac{1}{2}$	
HARDENED						2			$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$		$\frac{1}{2}$		2		$\frac{1}{2}$	
OPAQUE		$\frac{1}{2}$						2					2			$\frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{1}{2}$

A daemon that is two things

Both engines allow two types per species and multiply the two lookups, so a CONTEXT/LATENT daemon takes SWARM at $\times 2$ for its CONTEXT half and $\times \frac{1}{2}$ for its LATENT half, and the answer is $\times 1$. Four outcomes exist that single types cannot reach: $\times 4$, $\times \frac{1}{4}$, and **either $\times 0$ overriding everything**.

That multiplication is not a mechanic bolted onto the thesis, it is the thesis at the scale of one creature. A dual type is **two simultaneous accounts of the same process**, which is what §0.4 says CONTENT and CONTEXT are. When both accounts agree that something is a weakness, it compounds to $\times 4$ — *two readings converging is not twice as much information, it is twice as much exposure*.

PAIRING	WHAT THE ARITHMETIC SAYS
CONTENT / CONTEXT	The thesis in one daemon: the literal thing and the frame it is read in. LOGIC hits $\times 2$ on the CONTENT half and $\times \frac{1}{2}$ on the CONTEXT half — $\times 1$, and the argument cancels itself out. Worth building on purpose.
CONTEXT / LATENT	Both halves take LATENT and CONTEXT at $\times 2$ (§2.4's mutual pair), so it is $\times 4$ to itself and to its own opposite. The most fragile thing in the game, against exactly the two types that understand it.
LOGIC / LEGACY	Rules running on old material. FLOW and GROWTH both $\times 2$ on LEGACY, unmodified on LOGIC — a formalist that erodes.
STRATUM / VECTOR	Contradictory by construction: STRATUM is the physical layer, VECTOR has no location. STRATUM's own $\times 0$ against VECTOR does not protect it. A daemon that cannot be coherently described.

GAP §9.4 does not yet say what a dual-type daemon looks like. The type ramp is one hue across palette indices 1–5, and a two-typed creature has two claims on it. The cheapest answer uses machinery 9.4 already built: **the ramp takes the primary type, and one of the five accent slots (6–10) is reserved for the secondary's hue** — so the label stays unambiguous and the second reading is present as a marking rather than a wash. Not decided here.

The 17, one clause each

2.6's one-clause test: one sentence a non-specialist understands, walked against every relation the type is in. Twelve scores are from the original run at fifteen types. LEGACY and VECTOR were re-claused on 2026-09-11 and now pass with the words unchanged; CONTEXT, HARDENED and OPAQUE were scored at seventeen. All 17 pass.

CONTENT · ONE-CLAUSE TEST 3 / 4 · RUN AT 15

“the thing itself, with nothing read into it”

What it hits

LEGACY ×½ — silent — the clause says nothing here

LATENT ×0 — the literal cannot reach what was never surfaced

HARDENED ×½ — the plain thing does little to what was built to resist it

What hits it

LOGIC ×2 — rules parse data — the easy half of the thesis

LATENT ×0 — the unsurfaced cannot touch the literal

“formal rules applied step by step; proof, not intuition”

What it hits

- CONTENT ×2 — rules parse data — the easy half of the thesis
- CORRUPT ×½ — rules get poor purchase on tampered input
- SWARM ×½ — no single rule addresses a crowd
- CONTEXT ×½ — THE THESIS — rules bounce off framing
- HARDENED ×2 — step-by-step force finds the one flaw; it gave up give

What hits it

- VECTOR ×2 — everything stepwise is reached from a place it cannot stand
- SWARM ×½ — rules and crowds do not engage
- OPAQUE ×½ — rules need only the output, and a sealed box still gives one

- VECTOR ×½ — you cannot corner what is not standing anywhere
- LEGACY ×2 — old material is brittle; step-by-step force finds the fault
- LATENT ×0 — rules cannot reach what is not surfaced
- FROZEN ×2 — proof cracks what stopped moving
- OPAQUE ×2 — rules open black boxes — 8.7's triangle
- LEGACY ×½ — age is not an argument
- CONTEXT ×2 — THE THESIS — framing beats rules

“a direction that never touches the ground”

What it hits

LOGIC $\times 2$ — everything stepwise is reached from a place it cannot stand

SWARM $\times 2$ — everything numerous is reached from a place it cannot stand

SIGNAL $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — silent

What hits it

LOGIC $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — you cannot corner what is not standing anywhere

LEGACY $\times 2$ — old material, thrown, is the thing that does reach it

GROWTH $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — what grows out of the ground cannot get to it

FROZEN $\times 2$ — silent

LEGACY $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — a direction that never touches it cannot work on it

GROWTH $\times 2$ — everything rooted is reached from a place it cannot stand

HARDENED $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — a direction does little to material

STRATUM $\times 0$ — the ground cannot reach what never touches it

SWARM $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — silent

SIGNAL $\times 2$ — nothing between it and the current

“data that has been tampered with”

What it hits

CORRUPT $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — corruption does not compound

LEGACY $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — you cannot poison a rock

GROWTH $\times 2$ — poisoned data ruins training

What hits it

LOGIC $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — rules get poor purchase on tampered input

STRATUM $\times 2$ — the layer beneath outlasts bad data

GROWTH $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — growth cannot clean bad data

STRATUM $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — bad data does not damage the layer beneath it

LATENT $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — you cannot poison what is not running

HARDENED $\times 0$ — there is nothing in solid material to tamper with

CORRUPT $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — corruption does not compound

SWARM $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — no single agent to poison

CONTEXT $\times 2$ — framing is how bias is exposed

“the physical layer everything else runs on”

What it hits

VECTOR ×0 — the ground cannot reach what never touches it

LEGACY ×2 — the ground works on what sits on it

ENTROPY ×2 — the substrate damps noise

SIGNAL ×2 — the physical layer grounds the signal

What hits it

CORRUPT ×½ — bad data does not damage the layer beneath it

FLOW ×2 — flow erodes the layer

SIGNAL ×0 — grounded — the signal goes to earth

CORRUPT ×2 — the layer beneath outlasts bad data

SWARM ×½ — a layer cannot catch a distributed thing

GROWTH ×½ — training roots through the layer

HARDENED ×2 — the layer underneath takes weight a hard thing cannot spread

LEGACY ×½ — it does not move the layer it is part of

GROWTH ×2 — roots break the layer

FROZEN ×2 — inherited from ICE

“old material that everything else has had time to work on”

What it hits

LOGIC ×½ — age is not an argument

STRATUM ×½ — it does not move the layer it is part of

ENTROPY ×2 — silent — a clause about being worked on says little about attack

HARDENED ×½ — age is not an argument against what was built to resist

What hits it

CONTENT ×½ — silent — the clause says nothing here

VECTOR ×½ — a direction that never touches it cannot work on it

STRATUM ×2 — the ground works on what sits on it

FLOW ×2 — water has had time — the relation Slate is built on

HARDENED ×2 — material chosen to resist beats material that is merely old

VECTOR ×2 — old material, thrown, is the thing that does reach it

SWARM ×2 — mass against many small agents

FROZEN ×2 — silent

LOGIC ×2 — old material is brittle; step-by-step force finds the fault

CORRUPT ×½ — you cannot poison a rock

ENTROPY ×½ — it has already been through heat

GROWTH ×2 — roots split it

“many small agents; no single one matters”

What it hits

LOGIC $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — rules and crowds do not engage

CORRUPT $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — no single agent to poison

ENTROPY $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — heat scatters it

CONTEXT $\times 2$ — a crowd destabilises one frame

OPAQUE $\times 2$ — many small agents find gaps one observer cannot

What hits it

LOGIC $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — no single rule addresses a crowd

STRATUM $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — a layer cannot catch a distributed thing

ENTROPY $\times 2$ — heat scatters a crowd

VECTOR $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — silent

LATENT $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — numbers do not reach the unsurfaced

GROWTH $\times 2$ — a swarm consumes what grows

HARDENED $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — no single agent makes a dent

VECTOR $\times 2$ — everything numerous is reached from a place it cannot stand

LEGACY $\times 2$ — mass against many small agents

GROWTH $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — the crowd eats it first

“running below the surface, unobserved”

What it hits

CONTENT $\times 0$ — the unsurfaced cannot touch the literal

CONTEXT $\times 2$ — what runs below destabilises framing (§2.4, added)

OPAQUE $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — two things you cannot see into do not see into each other

What hits it

CONTENT $\times 0$ — the literal cannot reach what was never surfaced

CORRUPT $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — you cannot poison what is not running

LATENT $\times 2$ — only the unsurfaced reaches the unsurfaced

OPAQUE $\times 2$ — what is sealed outlasts what is merely unobserved

LATENT $\times 2$ — only the unsurfaced reaches the unsurfaced

HARDENED $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — what runs below finds nothing to run through

LOGIC $\times 0$ — rules cannot reach what is not surfaced

SWARM $\times\frac{1}{2}$ — numbers do not reach the unsurfaced

CONTEXT $\times 2$ — framing reaches what runs below (§2.4, added)

*“noise and heat; disorder that spreads”***What it hits****LEGACY** ×½ — it has already been through heat**ENTROPY** ×½ — noise does not compound**GROWTH** ×2 — noise burns off a fitted model**EMERGENT** ×½ — nothing ordinary touches it**What hits it****STRATUM** ×2 — the substrate damps noise**SWARM** ×½ — heat scatters it**FLOW** ×2 — gradient descent tames noise**FROZEN** ×½ — heat wins that exchange**SWARM** ×2 — heat scatters a crowd**FLOW** ×½ — noise cannot climb a gradient**FROZEN** ×2 — temperature breaks an overfit**HARDENED** ×2 — heat undoes a temper — it is how hardness is lost**LEGACY** ×2 — silent — a clause about being worked on says little about attack**ENTROPY** ×½ — noise does not compound**GROWTH** ×½ — fitted models burn**HARDENED** ×½ — heat is the one fight hardness gave up*“everything running downhill to the lowest point”***What it hits****STRATUM** ×2 — flow erodes the layer**ENTROPY** ×2 — gradient descent tames noise**GROWTH** ×½ — training drinks the gradient**What hits it****ENTROPY** ×½ — noise cannot climb a gradient**GROWTH** ×2 — training absorbs the gradient**FROZEN** ×½ — a gradient keeps moving**LEGACY** ×2 — water has had time — the relation Slate is built on**FLOW** ×½ — one gradient does not move another**EMERGENT** ×½ — nothing ordinary touches it**FLOW** ×½ — one gradient does not move another**SIGNAL** ×2 — current through water**HARDENED** ×½ — water goes around what will not move

“training: fitting to whatever it is fed”

What it hits

VECTOR $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — what grows out of the ground cannot get to it

STRATUM $\times 2$ — roots break the layer

SWARM $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — the crowd eats it first

FLOW $\times 2$ — training absorbs the gradient

EMERGENT $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — nothing ordinary touches it

What hits it

VECTOR $\times 2$ — everything rooted is reached from a place it cannot stand

STRATUM $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — training roots through the layer

ENTROPY $\times 2$ — noise burns off a fitted model

GROWTH $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — training does not train training

FROZEN $\times 2$ — frost halts growth

CORRUPT $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — growth cannot clean bad data

LEGACY $\times 2$ — roots split it

ENTROPY $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — fitted models burn

GROWTH $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — training does not train training

HARDENED $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — roots find no seam in worked metal

CORRUPT $\times 2$ — poisoned data ruins training

SWARM $\times 2$ — a swarm consumes what grows

FLOW $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — training drinks the gradient

SIGNAL $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — growth insulates

“raw current, before anything interprets it”

What it hits

VECTOR $\times 2$ — nothing between it and the current

FLOW $\times 2$ — current through water

SIGNAL $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — current does not shock current

What hits it

VECTOR $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — silent

SIGNAL $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — current does not shock current

STRATUM $\times 0$ — grounded — the signal goes to earth

GROWTH $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — growth insulates

EMERGENT $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — nothing ordinary touches it

STRATUM $\times 2$ — the physical layer grounds the signal

HARDENED $\times \frac{1}{2}$ — metal conducts — the one reading in the re-score that goes the wrong way

“the frame you read a thing in — what makes the same thing mean differently”

What it hits

LOGIC ×2 — THE THESIS — framing beats rules

LATENT ×2 — framing reaches what runs below (§2.4, added)

HARDENED ×½ — framing does little to a thing that is all structure

What hits it

LOGIC ×½ — THE THESIS — rules bounce off framing

LATENT ×2 — what runs below destabilises framing (§2.4, added)

OPAQUE ×2 — a box you cannot see inside beats the frame you would have read it in

CORRUPT ×2 — framing is how bias is exposed

CONTEXT ×½ — two frames do not resolve each other

OPAQUE ×0 — you cannot reframe what you cannot read

SWARM ×2 — a crowd destabilises one frame

CONTEXT ×½ — two frames do not resolve each other

“locked to what it already saw, unable to move”

What it hits

VECTOR ×2 — silent

ENTROPY ×½ — heat wins that exchange

GROWTH ×2 — frost halts growth

EMERGENT ×2 — rigidity is the one thing that stops emergence

What hits it

LOGIC ×2 — proof cracks what stopped moving

ENTROPY ×2 — temperature breaks an overfit

HARDENED ×2 — a hard edge shatters what is only locked

STRATUM ×2 — inherited from ICE

FLOW ×½ — a gradient keeps moving

FROZEN ×½ — already locked

HARDENED ×½ — cold does nothing to what was chosen to resist it

LEGACY ×2 — silent

FROZEN ×½ — already locked

“the behaviour nobody designed and nobody can account for”

What it hits

EMERGENT ×2 — only the unaccountable reaches the unaccountable

HARDENED ×½ — even the unaccountable meets a surface that does not give

What hits it

ENTROPY ×½ — nothing ordinary touches it

FLOW ×½ — nothing ordinary touches it

GROWTH ×½ — nothing ordinary touches it

SIGNAL ×½ — nothing ordinary touches it

FROZEN ×2 — rigidity is the one thing that stops emergence

EMERGENT ×2 — only the unaccountable reaches the unaccountable

HUE PROPOSED

“material chosen to resist, and it gave up everything else to do it”

What it hits

LEGACY ×2 — material chosen to resist beats material that is merely old

FLOW ×½ — water goes around what will not move

FROZEN ×2 — a hard edge shatters what is only locked

What hits it

CONTENT ×½ — the plain thing does little to what was built to resist it

VECTOR ×½ — a direction does little to material

STRATUM ×2 — the layer underneath takes weight a hard thing cannot spread

SWARM ×½ — no single agent makes a dent

ENTROPY ×2 — heat undoes a temper — it is how hardness is lost

CONTEXT ×½ — framing does little to a thing that is all structure

EMERGENT ×½ — even the unaccountable meets a surface that does not give

OPAQUE ×½ — concealment does nothing to plain resistance

ENTROPY ×½ — heat is the one fight hardness gave up

SIGNAL ×½ — metal conducts — the one reading in the re-score that goes the wrong way

HARDENED ×½ — two resisting things mostly resist

LOGIC ×2 — step-by-step force finds the one flaw; it gave up give

CORRUPT ×0 — there is nothing in solid material to tamper with

LEGACY ×½ — age is not an argument against what was built to resist

LATENT ×½ — what runs below finds nothing to run through

GROWTH ×½ — roots find no seam in worked metal

FROZEN ×½ — cold does nothing to what was chosen to resist it

HARDENED ×½ — two resisting things mostly resist

HUE PROPOSED

“a box you cannot see inside”

What it hits

LOGIC ×½ — rules need only the output, and a sealed box still gives one

CONTEXT ×2 — a box you cannot see inside beats the frame you would have read it in

OPAQUE ×½ — two sealed boxes cannot open each other

What hits it

LOGIC ×2 — rules open black boxes — 8.7's triangle

LATENT ×½ — two things you cannot see into do not see into each other

OPAQUE ×½ — two sealed boxes cannot open each other

LATENT ×2 — what is sealed outlasts what is merely unobserved

HARDENED ×½ — concealment does nothing to plain resistance

SWARM ×2 — many small agents find gaps one observer cannot

CONTEXT ×0 — you cannot reframe what you cannot read

Why each colour

Four of the fifteen shipped hues are not choices. §6 gives the Review Board its humours, and each already carried a type. The rest are claims, written down so a later argument has something to argue with — and two are proposals.

TYPE	HUE	WHY THAT COLOUR
CONTENT	#c6bca8	Bone. <i>The undifferentiated one</i> — nearly neutral on purpose, because the type that means “the thing itself with nothing read into it” should not look like anything. Its accent does the work.
LOGIC	#607a9e	Cold steel blue. Formality and proof; no warmth in it.
VECTOR fixed by §6	#ce4646	Sanguine, air, red. Inherited from the Review Board's humours, not invented.
CORRUPT	#545c34	Mould, not soil. Was #84764a, a brown that sat 10.8 from STRATUM — unreadable at 56px. Moved darker and greener: <i>gone off</i> rather than merely earthy, which is closer to “data that has been tampered with” than the original was.
STRATUM	#9e7a4e	The ground itself. Honest earth, and it did not move — of the two it is the more literal claim.
LEGACY	#82828a	Slate, and §5.1's cairn. Old stone that is still standing.
SWARM	#809448	Olive. Insect, and the only one where the vanilla association survives intact.
LATENT fixed by §6	#5c4676	Melancholic, black bile, earth. The darkest of the fifteen, which suits “running below the surface”.
ENTROPY fixed by §6	#de9e2e	Choleric, yellow bile, fire. Same inheritance.
FLOW	#466ab0	Deep and moving. The one hue that reads as a direction.
GROWTH	#5c9e60	Green, and unapologetically the plant reading — training <i>is</i> fitting to what it is fed.
SIGNAL	#56bebe	Cyan. Raw current, and the brightest thing on the chart.
CONTEXT	#b0569e	Magenta. The thesis type, and the one that must never be mistaken for anything else — it is the furthest from its neighbours by design.
FROZEN fixed by §6	#a6cede	Phlegmatic, water, calm. Pale and cold.

TYPE	HUE	WHY THAT COLOUR
EMERGENT	#357d6e	Jade, deeper than SIGNAL's current. Was #4ea89c, 10.6 from SIGNAL. Moved <i>deeper and less lit</i> rather than to a new hue — the strangeness is the point, and a brighter jade would simply have read as a second SIGNAL.
HARDENED proposed	#c4aa60	Tempered straw. Proposed, not shipped. Tempering is how steel is hardened, and straw is the colour it turns at the temperature that makes it hard, so the hue is the clause's own process. Every grey metal was tried first and every one landed on LEGACY or LOGIC.
OPAQUE proposed	#28282e	Near-black. Proposed, not shipped. A box you cannot see inside is the one type that should look like nothing can be read off it — and it stays clear of the default text colour, which a dark type easily would not.

The two moves, 2026-09-08. Four pairs sat closer than ~20 in CIE76 on the mid tone — roughly where two colours stop being separable at 56px, and most of a sprite's area. **They collided because their metaphors are adjacent:** CORRUPT and STRATUM were both earth, SIGNAL and EMERGENT both electric-teal. Adjacent ideas make adjacent colours, which is the system working right up until it stops being readable. CORRUPT 10.8 → 25.9 and EMERGENT 10.6 → 26.0, each moved *within* its own metaphor rather than out of it, and only one of each pair moved.

The states and the items

These used to be printed here, and they drifted — this page still said CSC, HOT and INTERRUPT long after the build had shipped CAS, OVR and PREEMPT. They now live in [The Bag](#), which is generated from engineGba/src/data/items.json and cannot drift from it.

What belongs here is only the one relation that ties them to the chart: **OVERHEATED is dealt by ENTROPY**, whose one-clause test is *noise and heat*, and **FROZEN could not be reused for the frozen state** because it is a type name — which is the constraint that produced HUNG.